

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, sunny, dry, windy in the southwest, high 71. **Tonight**, clear, dry, low 56. **Tomorrow**, intervals of clouds and sun, dry, warmer, high 80. Weather map is on Page D8.

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MONDAY, MAY 4, 2026

Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00



LAETTIA VANCON FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

A Center for Care and Kindness
Abbess Seraphima, center, with children at the House of Mercy in Odesa, which welcomes Ukrainians displaced by war. Page A8.

Behind Voting Rights Case, a Dispute Over the Reality of Racism

By **RICHARD FAUSSET**

In 1965, the year Congress passed the Voting Rights Act, it did not take much detective work to discover how some of the South’s most powerful white politicians felt about their Black neighbors.

Senator James Eastland, a Democrat from Mississippi who wanted to kill the landmark legislation, once openly stated that Black people were “an inferior race.” During his 1963 inaugura-

tion speech, Gov. George C. Wallace of Alabama, a Democrat, infamously declared, “Segregation now, segregation tomorrow, segregation forever.”

These days, such racism, at least when directed at Black people, is rarely openly expressed by white Southern politicians, who consider it to be immoral, bad politics, bad manners — or all of the above.

But a question central to the Southern experience lingers: Has anti-Black racism eased, or has discrimination against African

Critics of Decision Point to More Subtle Forms of Bias in System

Americans simply become more subtle, disguised as a web of rules embedded in regular partisan politics?

Last week, the Supreme Court strode once again into this fraught territory with a decision that weakened the Voting Rights Act,

the law that allowed many Black Southerners to finally participate in American democracy after decades of systemic oppression and exclusion.

At issue was the way in which the courts should determine whether a legislative map is racially discriminatory. Writing for the six-judge conservative majority, Justice Samuel A. Alito Jr. stated that from now on, anyone who wished to challenge a map on such grounds must show proof that the mapmakers had “inten-

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NICOLE TUNG FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Northern Lights Turn Into a Nightmare
As hordes of tourists chase the aurora borealis in Norway, scammers chase their money. Page A10.

Push to Define ‘Ultraprocessed’ Rattles Industry

By **JULIE CRESWELL** and **ALICE CALLAHAN**

Trying to devise a one-size-fits-all description for ultraprocessed foods is flummoxing federal regulators.

For months, the health secretary, Robert F. Kennedy Jr., has promised to create a definition of ultraprocessed, a crucial part of the Make America Healthy Again agenda. In mid-April, he testified before Congress that the Food and Drug Administration had for-

Fear of a Label Putting Limits on Food

warded a definition to other agencies, including the Department of Agriculture.

But behind the scenes, officials said, the process of defining ultraprocessed foods is still very much up in the air. Agencies are struggling to agree, and it is unclear when a definition will be released.

“It’s not final until it’s final,” said Calley Means, a senior adviser to Mr. Kennedy, adding that the definition would ultimately be the result of hundreds of conversations with scientists, agency staff and other stakeholders.

For the food industry, which is already seeing demand for many of its products soften as some consumers cut back on spending while others use weight-loss drugs, the debate about what an ultraprocessed food is or isn’t has

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3 Republicans Have a Mission: Expose Abusers

By **ANNIE KARNI**

WASHINGTON — When former Representative Tony Gonzales, Republican of Texas, admitted in March to a long-rumored affair with a staff member who later killed herself, a pair of Republican women immediately called for him to be formally censured, and a third became the first in the G.O.P. to demand that he resign.

The men at the helm of the party, President Trump and top Republican congressional leaders, were still standing by Mr. Gonzales, whose vote they needed to maintain their narrow majority in the House.

But among the small minority of G.O.P. lawmakers in the House who are women, an outspoken trio on the hard right — Representatives Anna Paulina Luna of Florida, Nancy Mace of South Carolina and Lauren Boebert of Colorado — went on offense and ultimately helped force Mr. Gonzales’s resignation in April under the threat of expulsion.

It was part of an unlikely campaign by three MAGA women to call out what they say is a culture of rampant sexual harassment and misconduct on Capitol Hill, and to dismantle the unwritten rules of political expediency and tribal loyalty that for decades have helped to keep such behavior under wraps.

“His staffer lit herself on fire and killed herself in the worst possible way, and he got a hall pass?” Ms. Mace said on Wednesday dur-

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Vision for Contained War Getting Away From Trump

President Still Voices No Regrets for Mission Whose Outcome Remains Unclear

By **ZOLAN KANNO-YOUNGS**

WEST PALM BEACH, Fla. — Two months into the war in Iran, President Trump is confronting the complicated reality of a conflict that has proved costly, deeply unpopular and lacks a clear endgame.

Energy markets are in turmoil. The Pentagon has given its first public estimate of the war’s cost: \$25 billion so far. Key Republicans in Congress are growing impatient. And Mr. Trump is lashing out at foreign allies, like Germany, who have shown no interest in joining the fight.

Speaking to a crowd of supporters in Florida on Friday, Mr. Trump insisted he had no regrets.

“I did something that was, I don’t know, foolish, brave, but it was smart,” Mr. Trump said at The Villages, a retirement community in a solidly Republican area. “I would do it again.”

Still, Mr. Trump’s predictions of a relatively short-term conflict with minimal economic consequences appear to be crumbling around him.

Mr. Trump has repeatedly defended the war, which he launched alongside Israel on Feb. 28, and said it is imperative that Iran never has a nuclear weapon. The United States and Israel have taken out military targets and killed senior Iranian leaders — including the supreme leader — but the government there remains intact and able to inflict pain on the United States.

As the conflict has continued, Mr. Trump has encouraged Americans to keep things “in perspective,” citing the long wars in Vietnam and Iraq to suggest that U.S. involvement in Iran is “not very long at all.”

Just three weeks ago, Mr. Trump said Iran had agreed to all of his demands, and he suggested that a breakthrough was near.

Iran would work with the United States to remove its enriched uranium, energy prices would drop and a growing global crisis with potential severe political ramifications would subside.

None of that happened.

Mr. Trump has issued mixed messages about the future of the war, arguing that Iran wanted to make a deal while also saying that the leadership in Tehran was so “disjointed” that it was hard to tell who was calling the shots. He also said it was not worth having his envoys travel 18 hours on a plane to negotiate a deal that might not come together.

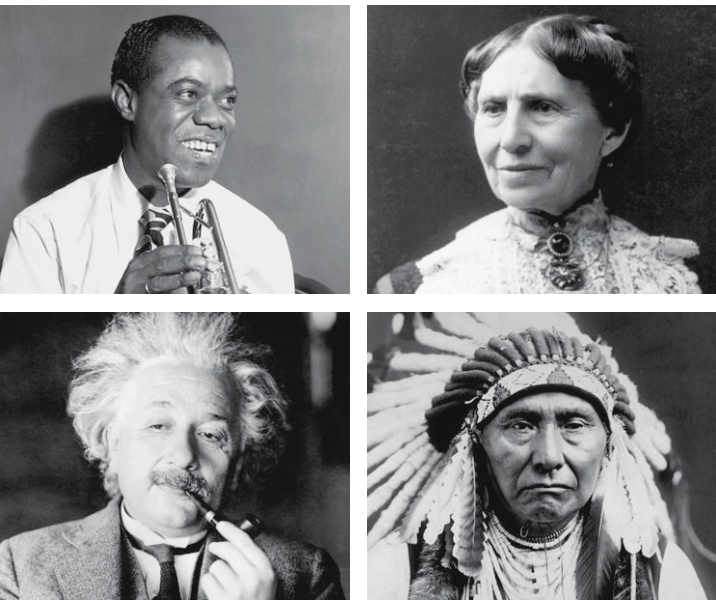
And on Friday, after saying he was not satisfied with Iran’s latest proposal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz, Mr. Trump said, “Frankly, maybe we’re better off not making a deal at all. Do you want to know the truth? Because we can’t let this thing go on.”

On Saturday, he appeared to double down, saying on social media that he was reviewing Iran’s latest proposal, though he couldn’t “imagine that it would be acceptable.”

Mr. Trump has said his model for Iran was the U.S. operation in Venezuela in January, when U.S. forces toppled its leader, Nicolás Maduro. But the two scenarios are very different. In Venezuela, only Mr. Maduro was ousted, while much of the rest of the government remained in place and chose to work with the Trump administration. That is not the case in Iran, in part because Iran’s leadership oversees extensive military capabilities.

For the moment, the two sides appear to be locked in a test of wills. Washington has maintained a blockade on Iranian shipping, and the Iranians have refused to

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Clockwise from top left: Louis Armstrong; Clara Barton, Red Cross founder; Chief Joseph of the Nez Perce; Albert Einstein.

President’s ‘Garden of Heroes’ Keeps Rising in Size and Cost

By **LUKE BROADWATER** and **ZACHARY SMALL**

WASHINGTON — President Trump’s vision for his National Garden of American Heroes is growing larger and most likely more expensive than his initial estimates, with the latest plans calling for reflecting pools, dining facilities and an amphitheater alongside 250 life-size statues of notable Americans.

The plans have expanded to the point that they could require significant redevelopment of West Potomac Park, an area of mostly sports fields near the National Mall, according to documents obtained by The New York Times.

The statues alone could cost more than the \$40 million approved for the project by Congress, according to the Trump administration’s estimate.

Based on the latest renderings, the Garden of Heroes could rank among the more expensive and time-consuming projects Mr. Trump has undertaken as he works to remake the nation’s capital in his own style.

Construction has yet to begin, raising questions about whether Mr. Trump will run out of time — and money — to deliver on his am-

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As U.S. brands stumble, China is finding success reaching young consumers in Indonesia with its products. PAGE B1

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Even in its reduced state, Spirit Airlines played a role in forcing others to keep fares low, some experts said. PAGE B1

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The U.S. indictment of a Mexican governor has spotlighted the Sinaloa Cartel’s political influence and has strained cross-border relations. PAGE A4

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Global demand for critical minerals is surging, igniting a wave of criminality in the world’s largest rainforest. PAGE A6

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Outlaw Country Personified
David Allan Coe, a Nashville outsider, wrote several hit songs, including “Take This Job and Shove It.” He was 86.

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Jessie Askew Jr. was sentenced to life without parole for a robbery with an unloaded gun. The man who sent him away pushed for his release. PAGE A11

Blaming Asia for U.S. Smog
The E.P.A. says American cities should not be penalized for foul air because pollution can come from abroad, an argument some experts reject. PAGE A16

Defying State He Wants to Run
Rom Reddy, a candidate for governor in South Carolina, has been fighting the state over a private sea wall he built to protect his mansion. PAGE A14



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Cherie DeVaux, once a pre-med student, became the first woman to train a Kentucky Derby winner. PAGE D6

A Little Help Means a Lot
Cam Schlittler, heeding a suggestion from his fellow Yankees pitcher Gerrit Cole, is now a top-end starter. PAGE D1

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